

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86REYKJAO02118

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ACTION EUR-00

INFO LOG-00 COPV-01 AOS-00 INR-10 SS-00 GIC-02 CIAE-00
ODDE-00 H-01 IO-19 NSCE-00 NSAE-00 SSD-00 HA-09
L-03 PM-10 PA-02 OMB-01 INRE-00 OES-09 ACOA-12
SCSC-04 SP-02 SNP-01 PRS-01 SARN-01 SOEL-02 SART-01
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-----315500 130803Z /11

O 130752Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY REYKJAVIK
TO USIA WASHDC IMMEDIATE 2975
INFO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 9842
AMEMBASSY MOSCOW IMMEDIATE
AMCONSUL Leningrad IMMEDIATE
NATO COLLECTIVE IMMEDIATE

UNCLAS SECTION 01 OF 02 REYKJAVIK 02118

E.O. 12356: N/A
SUBJECT: PROPAGANDA THEMES IN GENERAL SECRETARY
GORBACHEV'S OCTOBER 12 PRESS CONFERENCE

1. GENERAL SECRETARY MIKHAIL GORBACHEV WAS QUICK TO
APPEAR BEFORE THE PRESS FOLLOWING THE CONCLUSION OF THE
REYKJAVIK MEETINGS WITH PRESIDENT REAGAN TO PUT THE
SOVIET SPIN ON THE WEEKEND'S NEGOTIATIONS AND TO MAKE AN
INITIAL SOUNDING OF BASIC PROPAGANDA THEMES. GORBACHEV
WAS FLANKED ON THE PODIUM BY CENTRAL COMMITTEE SECRETARY
YAKOVLEV, FOREIGN MINISTER SHEVARNADZE, AMBASSADOR
DOBRYNIN, GENERAL AKHROMYEV AND HIS AIDE CHERNYAYEV.
HE TOOK AND ANSWERED QUESTIONS FOR ONE AND A HALF HOURS
(8:00 P.M. TO 9:30 P.M.). NUMEROUS SOVIET OFFICIALS
WERE ALSO PRESENT. TWO USIS OFFICERS OBTAINED PASSES
AND ATTENDED THE EVENT.

2. THROUGHOUT HIS PREPARED REMARKS AND HIS RESPONSES,
GORBACHEV, THE ONLY SPEAKER, REPEATED SEVERAL THEMES
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WHICH WILL UNDOUBTEDLY APPEAR SOON AS PART OF A
COMPREHENSIVE NEW SOVIET PROPAGANDA CAMPAIGN ON THE
ISSUE OF ARMS CONTROL. AMONG THE MORE IMPORTANT THEMES
ARE THE FOLLOWING:

A. -- THE SOVIETS TREATED THE DISCUSSIONS IN GENEVA WITH
GREAT SERIOUSNESS AND ATTEMPTED TO FOLLOW-UP ON THE
TALKS THERE WITH CAREFULLY PREPARED, FAR-RANGING ARMS
CONTROL PROPOSALS. THE REYKJAVIK MEETING IS FURTHER

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Date *11/14/89*

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() CLASSIFY as *OADR*
() DOWNGRADE TS to () S or () C, *OADR*

EVIDENCE OF SOVIET INTENTIONS.

B. -- THE SOVIETS HAVE DONE EVERYTHING THEY CAN TO FORMULATE "NEW THINKING" IN THE NUCLEAR AGE. GORBACHEV'S REFRAIN WAS THE NEED FOR "A NEW IMPULSE" AND "A NEW APPROACH."

C. -- HE SAID THIS IS AN HISTORIC MOMENT, A UNIQUE OPPORTUNITY. IT IS TIME FOR DARING AND BOLD, YET RESPONSIBLE DECISIONS. THE SOVIET UNION IS MAKING SUCH PROPOSALS AND IS READY TO TAKE THE NECESSARY DECISIONS. THE U.S. IS NOT. GORBACHEV SUGGESTED THAT PERHAPS THE PRESIDENT WAS UNABLE TO MAKE DECISIONS AT THE REYKJAVIK MEETING, THAT HE WAS IN "THE GRIP OF THE MILITARY-INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX."

D. -- THE AMERICANS CAME TO THE MEETING "EMPTY-HANDED." GORBACHEV REPEATED ON SEVERAL OCCASIONS THE SAME PHRASE ABOUT THE ADMINISTRATION'S "EMPTY HANDS" IN CONTRAST TO A SOVIET PORTFOLIO BULGING WITH ARMS PROPOSALS. ON ONE OCCASION GORBACHEV SAID THE AMERICANS CAME WITH "BARE, EMPTY HANDS" (GOLYYE, PUSTYYE RUKI) AND ONCE WITH "EMPTY HANDS AND EMPTY POCKETS."

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E. -- GORBACHEV SAID THE SOVIETS HAVE PRESENTED A COMPREHENSIVE THREE-PART PACKAGE TO END THE ARMS RACE AND ELIMINATE THE NUCLEAR THREAT TO THE WORLD AND THE AMERICANS HAVE REJECTED IT. A MAJOR PORTION OF GORBACHEV'S REMARKS WAS DEVOTED TO CAREFULLY LEADING THE AUDIENCE DOWN A WELL-CRAFTED PATH AND THEN TO SPRINGING THE TRAP. HE DISCUSSED THE ISSUE OF REDUCTIONS IN STRATEGIC ARSENALS, POINTED OUT THE MAJOR CONCESSIONS THE SOVIETS WERE WILLING TO MAKE AND SAID THAT THEIR AMERICAN INTERLOCUTORS HAD AGREED TO THESE PROPOSALS DURING THE COURSE OF THE MEETINGS. HE THEN REVIEWED INF, NOTED OTHER MAJOR SOVIET CONCESSIONS AND ANNOUNCED AN AGREEMENT WITH THE UNITED STATES ON INF AS WELL. THEN HE CAME TO PART THREE. WHILE WE ARE REDUCING OUR ARSENALS, GORBACHEV SAID, WE MUST AGREE THAT WE WILL NOT UNDERTAKE ANY ACTIVITIES WHICH WILL PERMIT THE DEVELOPMENT OF NEW WEAPONRY. WE CANNOT SIMULTANEOUSLY REDUCE IN ONE AREA AND EXPAND IN ANOTHER. THIS WOULD NOT BE SENSIBLE AND WOULD NOT LEAD TO PEACE. THE AMERICANS, HE WENT ON TO SAY, COULD NOT AGREE TO THIS. THE U.S. SIDE INSISTED ON ITS RIGHT TO TEST SPACE WEAPONS OUTSIDE THE LABORATORY. THE WHOLE PACKAGE, THEREFORE, COLLAPSED IN THE FACE OF U.S. INTRANSIGENCE OVER SDI.

F. -- THE SOVIETS ARE PREPARED TO TAKE RISKS AND MAKE

CONCESSIONS FOR THE SAKE OF ARMS CONTROL.

G. -- THE WORLD WOULD REGARD AS "SCANDALOUS" A SUMMIT IN WASHINGTON IN WHICH NOTHING WAS DECIDED. THERE MUST BE SOME PROGRESS IN ARMS CONTROL OR WHAT WILL THE WORLD THINK OF LEADERS WHO MEET THREE TIMES AND COME TO NO AGREEMENTS.

H. -- AMERICA STILL PURSUES THE CHIMERA OF MILITARY SUPERIORITY.
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L-03 PM-10 PA-02 OMB-01 JNRE-00 OES-09 ACOA-12
SCSC-04 SP-02 SNP-01 PRS-01 SARN-01 SOEL-03 SART-01
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O 130752Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY REYKJAVIK
TO USIA, WASHDC IMMEDIATE 2976
INFO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 9843
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AMCONSUL Leningrad IMMEDIATE
NATO COLLECTIVE IMMEDIATE

UNCLAS SECTION 02 OF 02 REYKJAVIK 02118

E.O. 12256 N/A
SUBJECT: PROPAGANDA THEMES IN GENERAL SECRETARY

I. -- THE SOVIET UNION IS PATIENT, IT WILL NOT WITHDRAW
ITS PROPOSALS. IT WILL WAIT FOR THE WORLD (INCLUDING THE
AMERICAN PEOPLE) TO CONSIDER THE MATTER. THE SOVIET
UNION WILL NOT WAVER FROM THE PATH TOWARD ELIMINATING
THE NUCLEAR THREAT.

J. -- THE SET OF MEETINGS FELL THROUGH, BUT NO DOORS
ARE CLOSED. PROGRESS WAS MADE; NEW UNDERSTANDINGS WERE
ARRIVED AT. THERE ARE STILL TALKS AND CONTACTS TO
PURSUE AND THERE IS STILL REASON FOR CONTINUED DIALOGUE
BETWEEN THE TWO LEADERS.

3. COMMENT: GORBACHEV INITIATED THE PRESS CONFERENCE
IN A SPIRIT OF OPENNESS, BUT, AS HE PURSUED HIS THEME OF
AMERICAN INDECISIVENESS IN THE FACE OF SOVIET INNOVATION
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AND FLEXIBILITY, HE BECAME MORE UPBEAT AND EMPHASIZED
HIS OWN OPTIMISM THAT THE REYKJAVIK MEETING, WITH ITS
OPEN AND BUSINESSLIKE DISCUSSIONS, MIGHT EVEN BE
REGARDED AS BRINGING THE TWO SIDES CLOSER TOGETHER. AT
ONE POINT IN HIS BRIEFING, GORBACHEV APPEARED TIRED BUT
PULLED HIMSELF TOGETHER TO LINK HIS PROPOSALS FOR ARMS
REDUCTION WITH THE PRESERVATION OF HUMANITY. GORBACHEV
WAS CLEARLY IN CONTROL OF HIS AUDIENCE AND WHEN HE
SPOKE, NOT A SOUND COULD BE HEARD BUT THE WHIRRING OF

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CAMERAS. HE CLOSED HIS BRIEFING WITH SEVERAL QUIPS TO
HIS AUDIENCE AND A SMILING GOOD-BYE IN ENGLISH. END
COMMENT. IVDY

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